A Pale Imitation

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/54316849.

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Explicit

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Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Catra/Not-Adora

Characters:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Not-Adora (aka random blonde)

Additional Tags:
Porn with Feelings, Vaginal Fingering, nightclubs, Angst, Public Sex, Jealousy, Yearning, Having sex with your crush's doppelganger because you think you can't have sex with them, Said crush witnesses the act, Not Actually Unrequited Love, Rough Kissing, Guilt, Sex with a stranger, conflicted feelings, Opportunistic Sex

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by InErosion

Summary

If it's all just a means to an end, then this is how it goes: with Not-Adora winding an arm up and around Catra's shoulder blades, with her other hand resting on Catra's waist, and with her desperate, silent whimpers betraying her pent up fervor.

This is the attraction of this breed of establishment, isn't it?

The people that come here want to be swallowed whole. They're impulsive. They do not want to waste their days or nights waiting for something to 'maybe happen', so they don't. Instead, they come here and they act without thinking past the moment they're in.

———

Upset and confused, Catra yearns for Adora but finds someone else instead. What she doesn't know is that Adora is searching for her too.

Notes

Heyo.

Here be a bit of a writing exercise that I did to help stretch my writing muscles again. Short and dense, the challenge here was to limit dialogue (sorry banter my beloved) and ofc to write smut again.

Also, for clarity's sake: this is 100% a Catradora fic, imo. It is not an OC/Catra fic or similar as the OC is Catra's blatant stand-in for Adora and Catra's obsessing over Adora the entire time lol.

See the end of the work for more notes

“Try not to back yourself into a corner with all this,” Glimmer advised Catra before they left.

Catra had narrowed her eyes. “And where's that coming from?”

“It's coming from someone who's been there. Don’t make a big deal out of it, alright? Just trust me on this. It's gonna go fine.”

“Just don't make a big deal out of it. Yeah right, sure. Screw that,” Catra growls.

Because Adora is supposed to be here. She's supposed to be right here, right now, with Catra. But Adora isn't anywhere to be found. It's as if she vanished off the face of the Earth.

Now it's this late into the evening, there's really no coming back from that. Glimmer's reassurances mean nothing. Catra is over it. She needs an out and she needs it fast, before she sees something she can't ever unsee.

(She should never have agreed to this outing.)

It's not as if she really wanted to come here in the first place. It isn't only the stench of sweat, sex, liquor and urine; it's also the low visibility, deafening music, and strobe lights pulsing ad nauseam. All of these aspects play their subtle parts in why Catra doesn't belong in a place such as this.

The fact is that she doesn't care for it. Why should she? It certainly doesn't care for her.

(But it should. It should finally get the hint and take notice. If only Adora—)

Someone collides with Catra. The impact is violent enough that were she not caught by the mass of bodies around her, she would

have fallen. Catra immediately curses, poised to cast the offender a look of disdain… or maybe even get into a fight.

Instead, she finds herself doing something extraordinarily rare: a double take.

Except no, she quickly realizes, *this person is not Adora.*

The woman standing in front of Catra is merely a lookalike, an imitation. She's tall, blonde, athletic, and apparently even clumsy - everything Catra could ever want. With a little more effort done into that ponytail, maybe she could pass for…

Another sudden bump from a stranger pushes them back into each other. Be it from alcohol, Catra's presence, or some other combination of inebriation, the woman's pale complexion makes her sudden blush as clear as day, even in the dim light. The laugh that follows is entirely muted in comparison to the blaring music, but it's obvious nonetheless.

It's all so very obvious in how her hands are still caught on Catra's bare midriff (she doesn't pull away, not like Adora would). It's obvious in how she's looking down, eyes dark, like suddenly, Catra is the only person in the universe. Like this is a fantasy and they’re star-crossed lovers that just happened to fall into each other's arms.

(And to her credit, she actually looks at Catra. She holds her gaze.)

Catra’s throat goes bone dry. She senses a heat. Lust, anger… She doesn't yet know, but it surges through her body, threatening to boil over.

Then the woman smiles at her.

(Lust.)

In a split second, Catra decides to abandon her search for the exit. The shift is seamless. Her shoulders, her eyes, her entire

demeanor relaxes, if only for this moment. Her gaze flickers to the woman’s slightly parted, slightly chapped lips.

(It's as easy as that.)

Their lips connect. Catra moves her hands up to cup the woman's face and hold her in place. She thinks to herself that the only fitting name for this woman is *'Not-Adora',* then hums a husky laugh into the kiss, which is reciprocated with a moan.

(It should be this easy all the time.)

Catra uses the heels of her palms to cradle Not-Adora’s jaw. The tips of her fingers dig harshly into her scalp, tugging and twisting that hair until the moans morph into whines - whines that are deftly stifled by Catra's tongue. It's not long before there's a light tap on Catra's chest, which is quickly followed up by several more, all with more urgency. It's a request for air.

(Catch and release.)

So, Catra relinquishes her grasp, smirking as Not-Adora gulps down humid air. She allows her partner just enough time to catch her breath before firmly reeling her back in.

(Or not.)

If it's all just a means to an end, then this is how it goes: with Not-Adora winding an arm up and around Catra's shoulder blades, with her other hand resting on Catra's waist, and with her desperate, silent whimpers betraying her pent up fervor.

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That is what this woman is doing right now, practically crushed against Catra's body.

(It's what they're both doing. Catra is beginning to like it just as much as she's beginning to hate it.)

Catra tugs on Not-Adora's ponytail with harsh insistence and draws a sharp gasp from her lips. After that, she lets one hand wander down until it settles on the woman's throat.

(Although it's best not to think too hard about these things.)

Somewhere along the way, they both devolve into a mess of heavy panting. Not-Adora’s hot breath sticks to Catra's skin. On the other end, Catra's grip has somewhat unconsciously found its way to the woman's hips. Apparently, the move is taken as a suggestion, because an eager hand reaches down towards Catra's crotch. Catra instinctively catches the woman's wrist and holds it still.

Not-Adora’s expression immediately turns into one of concern. It's perhaps the most striking and unnervingly familiar thing she's done so far.

(Catra's heart all but stutters to a halt.)

In the midst of her shock, it takes an extra second for her to register that Not-Adora’s lips are moving. Her lips—

She's trying to converse.

What's worse, Catra can hear some of it.

(She wasn't expecting to be able to hear anyone in here. That variable never factored in.)

It's muffled, probably still incredibly difficult to parse even for regular club goers, but the woman's voice is unquestionably there.

“Are you good?” she asks.

Catra hastily nods, feeling sweat form on her temple and palms. She scans her surroundings; they're different than before. It seems that she hasn't been aware enough to notice the crowd pushing them away from the center of the dance floor. That must be why it's quieter here, even if only just.

(It's enough noise reduction that Catra can almost hear herself think… and that's not something she can handle right now.)

Her attention snaps back to Not-Adora.

“Actually, I need you,” she says, voice low and raspy. Her hands find their way back onto Not-Adora’s hips. “Let me…”

“Try not to back yourself into a corner with all this,” Glimmer advised Catra before they left.

Catra had narrowed her eyes. “And where's that coming from?”

“It's coming from someone who's been there. Don’t make a big deal out of it, alright? Just trust me on this. It's gonna go fine.”

Funny, because now Catra is actually backing herself into a corner. Or, more specifically, Not-Adora is. Not that Not-Adora really has control, of course. Because it's *Catra* who is aggressively unbuttoning her partner’s jeans - not the other way around.

“Oh, you really—”

“Shh.”

Catra all but shoves her hand down the front of Not-Adora’s jeans. There's no grace to it, no love, even - but that's more than fine. Not-Adora is clearly soaked. She chokes on her words the moment Catra brushes her clit.

The position isn't the most comfortable, no. Actually, it's awful. Catra's wrist is at a horrible angle, cramping up in an already cramped environment. She does her best to brace herself against the wall, creating a few extra inches of space, then continues. She

continues until her fingers slip their way inside, only testing once or twice before furiously beginning to pump.

Not-Adora's head instantly dips as she groans and shudders. It isn't long before she's clutching on to Catra for support, whimpering incoherently as she is mercilessly driven toward her peak.

Catra cannot help but stare.

There's something in how the woman's chest rises and falls, in how she's sweating, and in how she's unable to hold eye contact for more than mere seconds at a time. It's as if Catra is breaking down her resolve one brick at a time with each rhythmic pulse. It's a mesmerizing image torn straight from Catra's darkest desires, and it's almost like it's come to life.

Almost.

Catra's eyes go wide.

(A 'poor' imitation. Not even close. Right, not even…)

As she senses the inevitable steadily build, she has to remind herself that this woman is not Adora. The truth is terrible enough to tear Catra in two, but not nearly terrible enough to make her stop what she's started.

And so when the time comes, she just… lets it happen.

She lets it happen with her heart thundering uncomfortably in her chest. Not-Adora holds Catra as she rides out her orgasm. She holds her as though their entanglement was destined to be.

But it isn't— *wasn't.*

(And there's that dread.)

It's just… a slip up. It's…

Though Not-Adora eventually relaxes, Catra does not. Instead, she's struck with horror. A suffocating lump blocks her throat as she realizes that *that* is Adora. The real Adora is standing only a few short paces away, having stopped dead in her tracks at the edge of the crowd. She’s staring at Catra with both a look and an intensity that Catra has never seen before.

Catra does not know what to say, not that she can feasibly speak. She also does not have any idea what to think… Her mind is paralyzed by Adora's frozen expression. Eventually, Catra does the only thing she can: she wipes her hand clean using the front of Not-Adora’s shirt, then slowly steps out from her spot against the wall.

End Notes

It's so like me to randomly write a Catradora smut fic where Adora gets screwed, but not fucked.

But fr even when I balance things out and think I'm about to lay all the angst on Catra, Adora still gets it rough. Well… again, not exactly that. Oops.

Anyways, Adora. Lighten up. This went a lot worse for you in the first draft. :D

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!